

ANGEL ACTION · ALLERGY

Anaphylaxis

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Recognise anaphylaxis

Any **one** of these after exposure to an allergen is anaphylaxis:

- Difficult or noisy breathing
- Swelling of the tongue
- Swelling or tightness in the throat
- Difficulty talking and/or hoarse voice
- Wheeze or persistent cough
- Persistent dizziness or collapse
- Pale and floppy (young children)

Mild symptoms may include hives, swelling of lips and eyes, abdominal pain or vomiting. These can rapidly progress.

What to do

1. **Lay the person flat.** Do NOT let them stand or walk — this can cause sudden death. If breathing is hard, allow them to sit with legs out, but never stand.
2. **Give adrenaline** with an autoinjector (EpiPen) into the outer mid-thigh — through clothing is fine. Hold for **3 seconds**.
3. **Call 000.**
4. After 5 minutes, if there is no improvement, **give a second dose** if available.
5. If the person becomes unresponsive and is not breathing normally, start **CPR**.
6. If they have asthma symptoms as well, give adrenaline first, then a **blue asthma reliever**.

Using an EpiPen

1. Form a fist around the EpiPen — **blue to the sky, orange to the thigh**.
2. Pull off the blue safety cap.
3. Place the orange end firmly against the outer mid-thigh and push until it clicks.
4. Hold for 3 seconds.
5. Massage the area for 10 seconds.
6. Note the time so you know when to give the second dose.

*Adapted from **Australian First Aid 5th Edition**. Get the full guide and live CPR metronome at firstaidangel.org.*